

Chapter 44-2: Fluffy

Time slowly passed. Since that day, Ning Fuyi hadn't seen Chu Qingqiu again. Finally, on the thirtieth day after Jiang Li's arrival, news came from Tranquil Mountain Palace that Divine Venerable Chu Ling had recovered, causing the entire sect to celebrate.

At that time, Ning Fuyi was practicing swordplay with Liu Wenzhu on the back mountain. There was a large clearing covered with fallen leaves, facing a cliff. Below the cliff, white clouds rolled, and in the distance, some mist-wreathed mountain peaks were visible, like ink wash paintings.

Liu Wenzhu's magical instrument was the complete opposite of her own gentle, delicate appearance—it was a thousand-pound hammer as big as a washbasin, weighing a full thousand pounds. It was now moving with great force in her slender arms.

Ning Fuyi held the divine sword in her hand, her figure like wind and tree shadows, spinning and maneuvering in mid-air. Light pink immortal energy intertwined with Liu Wenzhu's flames, creating an indescribable harmony.

After the divine sword collided with the thousand-pound hammer, there was a muffled sound. In the distance, the only remaining tree responded by breaking, its crown crashing miserably to the ground. Only then did the two stop, landing lightly.

"Yiyi, your cultivation has improved quite a bit these past few days—you can actually fight me to a draw!" Liu Wenzhu said joyfully. She spun the giant hammer in her palm once before putting it away, then quickly ran toward Ning Fuyi.

Ning Fuyi forced out a smile and put away her divine sword as well. Although her cultivation had improved, the pink color that permeated every time she cast spells gave her quite a headache.

It seemed that ever since her cultivation had greatly increased, her immortal energy always appeared as a striking pink no matter how she used it. When others cast spells, they looked imposing, but when it came to her, it was as charming as... something or other.

A demon king who in her previous life had devoured thunder and breathed lightning with great majesty now had immortal energy that looked like this—it was like the King of Hell doing a seductive dance. The more she thought about it, the more bizarre it seemed.

Ning Fuyi irritably patted the dust off her clothes and beckoned to Ping An, who was hiding nearby watching their sparring match. Ping An happily barked a few times and came running, leaping into Ning Fuyi's arms.

Ning Fuyi's waist immediately went soft, and she nearly fell backward. Fortunately, Liu Wenzhu was quick to support her, saving her from falling.

The first thing troubling her recently—Ning Fuyi angrily patted Ping An. When had Ping An ever been this fat in her previous life? Its fluffy body had swollen into a ball, its four legs embedded in white fur and kicking about. If you didn't look carefully, you couldn't even find its head.

"From now on, I'll have to hang a sign around your neck: 'Only one meal per day.' If you keep eating like this, you'll really die of obesity," Ning Fuyi said, throwing it back to the ground to rescue her arms.

Ping An happily bounced around her.

Liu Wenzhu covered her mouth and laughed at this. Just as she was about to say something, she was interrupted by the transmission tablet at Ning Fuyi's waist: "Cloud Deep Hall, come quickly."

It was Elder Pingyao's voice, sounding quite urgent. Ning Fuyi handed Ping An over to Liu Wenzhu to take back, while she herself hurried to Cloud Deep Hall.

As soon as she entered, she felt a cold wind blowing across her back. The hair on her arms immediately stood up, making her flesh crawl, and her hand instinctively reached for her storage bead.

"Ning Fuyi." At this moment, a stern voice called her name. Looking up, she saw Elder Pingyao with a weary face, gesturing for her to come over.

The great hall, which should have been as bright as the outside world, was now very dim. When Ning Fuyi walked in, the door closed. She could only apply some immortal energy to her eyelids to see clearly the people standing in the hall.

All the important figures were present. She saw Chu Qingqiu and Mei Chengsi among them. In addition, there was a strange person in white clothes standing in the corner, with disheveled hair, looking like an upside-down broom from a distance.

When she got closer, Ning Fuyi turned her head away in disgust. She saw that this person's tongue was hanging out long, his eye sockets were two bloody holes, and two streaks of blood flowed down from the holes, dripping constantly.

"Ning Fuyi, this is a judge from the underworld," Elder Pingyao said. She also seemed reluctant to look at the judge's face, only giving a cursory introduction.

Ning Fuyi symbolically nodded at him. The judge's head turned toward her with creaking sounds, his sticky tongue swaying up and down.

Ning Fuyi closed her eyes.

At this moment, Chu Qingqiu's voice rang out, saying coldly: "Since the underworld has sent someone to ask for my help, I agree. But only I alone can go—there's no need to implicate others."

"The underworld is in chaos. Emperor Fengdu¹ has made it clear that only the Divine Venerable can resolve this situation. But the Divine Venerable has a supremely yang constitution—too much yang energy. If ten thousand evil ghosts recognize you, it will certainly be troublesome," the judge with the hanging tongue said unclearly. "Only by having a supremely yin person beside you, with sufficient yin energy, can you blend in among the multitude of ghost souls."

As he spoke, his two bloody holes turned toward Ning Fuyi.

Without needing further explanation, Ning Fuyi knew who this supremely yin person referred to.

"But didn't the judge just say that the underworld cannot admit living people, and even if it could, only one person would be allowed to enter? Isn't this contradictory?" Elder Pingyao said sternly.

"Not contradictory, not contradictory." The judge gave a sinister laugh, pointing his pale finger at Ning Fuyi. Ning Fuyi's vision quickly became covered with a layer of mist.

She quickly tried to wave it away with her fluffy paws, but instantly lost her balance and sat down hard on the ground. Opening her eyes, a pair of big feet appeared before her.

Looking up again, the enormously enlarged Elder Pingyao was looking down at her with a dark expression!

Footnotes:

¹ **Emperor Fengdu (酆都大帝)** - In Chinese mythology, the ruler of the underworld, also known as the Lord of the Dead or King of the Underworld.